

James & Proverbs

A Wisdom Parallel

James reads as the book of Proverbs in New Testament clothes. Both books are written as wisdom literature for daily faithfulness. Twelve parallels below show how James drew his teaching from Solomon's well.

THEME	JAMES	PROVERBS
Wisdom is a gift from God	James 1:5 But if any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask of God, who gives to all generously and without reproach, and it will be given to him.	Proverbs 2:6 For the LORD gives wisdom; from His mouth come knowledge and understanding.
Wealth withers like grass	James 1:10-11 ...the rich man is to glory in his humiliation, because like flowering grass he will pass away. For the sun rises with a scorching wind and withers the grass...	Proverbs 11:28 He who trusts in his riches will fall, but the righteous will flourish like the green leaf.
Slow to anger	James 1:19 ...let everyone be quick to hear, slow to speak and slow to anger.	Proverbs 14:29 He who is slow to anger has great understanding, but he who is quick-tempered exalts folly.
Restrain the tongue	James 1:26 If anyone thinks himself to be religious, and yet does not bridle his tongue but deceives his own heart, this man's religion is worthless.	Proverbs 10:19 When there are many words, transgression is unavoidable, but he who restrains his lips is wise.
Do not show favoritism	James 2:1 My brethren, do not hold your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ with an attitude of personal favoritism.	Proverbs 24:23 To show partiality in judgment is not good.
Honor the poor	James 2:6 But you have dishonored the poor man. Is it not the rich who oppress you and personally drag you into court?	Proverbs 14:21 He who despises his neighbor sins, but happy is he who is gracious to the poor.
The tongue is fire	James 3:6 And the tongue is a fire, the very world of iniquity; the tongue is set among our members as that which defiles the entire body...	Proverbs 16:27 A worthless man digs up evil, while his words are like scorching fire.
Wisdom from above	James 3:17 But the wisdom from above is first pure, then peaceable, gentle, reasonable, full of mercy and good fruits, unwavering, without hypocrisy.	Proverbs 4:7 The beginning of wisdom is: Acquire wisdom; and with all your acquiring, get understanding.

VERSEMATE
James & Proverbs — continued

THEME	JAMES	PROVERBS
Quarrels from desire	James 4:1 What is the source of quarrels and conflicts among you? Is not the source your pleasures that wage war in your members?	Proverbs 13:10 Through insolence comes nothing but strife, but wisdom is with those who receive counsel.
God opposes the proud	James 4:6 But He gives a greater grace. Therefore it says, 'God is opposed to the proud, but gives grace to the humble.'	Proverbs 3:34 Though He scoffs at the scoffers, yet He gives grace to the afflicted.
Do not boast of tomorrow	James 4:13-14 Come now, you who say, 'Today or tomorrow we will go to such and such a city...' Yet you do not know what your life will be like tomorrow.	Proverbs 27:1 Do not boast about tomorrow, for you do not know what a day may bring forth.
Love covers sins	James 5:20 ...he who turns a sinner from the error of his way will save his soul from death and will cover a multitude of sins.	Proverbs 10:12 Hatred stirs up strife, but love covers all transgressions.